

Jose J. Alcocer

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CONTACT INFORMATION

Harvard Law School
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CURRENT PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Applied Research Statistician, 2025 –
Harvard Law School
[Department of Empirical Research Services](#)

Data Architect, 2025 –
University of Southern California
[Everyday Respect Project](#)

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science and International Relations, 2025
University of Southern California, Dornsife College of Letters, Arts, and Sciences

Master of Public Policy (M.P.P.), 2019
University of Southern California, Sol Price School of Public Policy

B.A. in Political Science, 2017
California State University, Long Beach, College of Liberal Arts

EXPERTISE

Methodological: Artificial Intelligence (Large Language Models, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Uncertainty Quantification), Measurement & Psychometrics (Item Response Theory, Latent Variable Modeling, Scale Development, Construct Validity), Quantitative Research Design (Cross-Sectional, Experimental, Longitudinal, Quasi-Experimental), Research Data Architecture (Database Design, Multi-Modal & Multi-Dimensional Data Integration, Research Infrastructure Design), Statistical Inference (Causal, Descriptive, Predictive)

Substantive: Electoral Systems, Elite Behavior, Intersectionality, Latin American Politics, Legislative Institutions, Public Policy Analysis, Race and Ethnicity, U.S. Election Law, U.S. Politics, U.S. Voting Rights

SOFTWARE

[5] 2026. [Transcript De-identification Review](#): Browser-based, fully local tool for human review of automated text de-identification, with span-level tagging by PII type and error type and long-format CSV export. Built as a Shiny app in R and compiled to WebAssembly so data never leaves the user's machine. Sole author.

[4] 2026. [rustgd](#): R package providing native desktop viewer windows—plots, data frames, and HTML widgets/Shiny apps—for terminal and editor R workflows that lack an IDE's GUI panes. Rendering and table core written in Rust via extendr. Sole author.

[3] 2024. [TextViz Studio](#): Browser-based, no-code platform bringing text-as-data methods (transformer topic modeling via BERTopic/GPT-4o, multilingual sentiment analysis, keyword visualization) and a full regression and statistical-testing suite to social scientists. Python backend; publication-ready figure and LaTeX export. Sole author.

[2] 2024. [AppendIDs](#): R package for merging cross-national datasets that use incompatible country-coding schemes (Gleditsch-Ward, Correlates of War, IFS). Co-author.

[1] 2024. [topicmodelCV](#). R package for choosing the number of topics (k) in LDA topic models via 10-fold cross-validation, comparing perplexity, held-out likelihood, and semantic coherence across candidate values. Sole author.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[5] Sierra-Arévalo, Michael, **Jose J. Alcocer**, Lauren Brown, Raquel Delerme, Benjamin A.T. Graham, Harry G. Muttram, Jackson Trager, and Nicholas Weller. 2026. "[Police as Policymakers: How experiences with policy implementation shape policy representation.](#)" *Political Research Quarterly*. OnlineFirst.

[4] Golazizian, Preni, Elnaz Rahmati, Jackson Trager, Zhivar Sourati, Nona Ghazizadeh, Yiorgos Chochlakis, **Jose J. Alcocer***, Kerby Bennett*, Aarya Vijay Devnani*, Parsa Hejabi*, Harry G. Muttram*, Akshay Kiran Padte*, Mehrshad Saadatinia*, Chenhao Wu*, Alireza S. Zaibari*, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, Nick Weller, Shrikanth Narayanan, Benjamin A.T. Graham, and Morteza Dehghani. 2026. "[The Subjectivity of Respect in Police Traffic Stops: Modeling Community Perspectives in Body-Worn Camera Footage.](#)" In *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association of Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, ed. Maria Liakata, Viviane P. Moreira, Jiajun Zhang, and David Jurgens, 33939-33961. San Diego, CA: ACL.

[3] Múzquiz, José and **Jose J. Alcocer**. 2025. "[Legislator Responsiveness to Racialized Constituencies in Mexico.](#)" *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, pp. 1-13.

[2] **Alcocer, Jose J.** 2025. "[Minority Elites Sponsor and Cosponsor Differently from Whites: Causal Evidence from U.S. Congress.](#)" *Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics*, 10(2), pp. 277-289.

[1] **Alcocer, Jose J.** 2020. "[Exploring the Effect of Colorado's Recreational Marijuana Policy on Opioid Overdose Rates.](#)" *Public Health*, 185, pp. 8-14.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

[6] **Alcocer, Jose J.** and Christian R. Grose. 2026. "[What Does the USC Formula from the Cancelled Governor's Debate Teach Us? Candidate Viability Scores Predict Primary Vote Shares in California.](#)" *Medium*.

[5] Rosalía Chávez Zárata, Marlene Orozco, **Jose J. Alcocer**, and George Foster. 2026. "[2025 State of Latino Entrepreneurship](#)." *Stanford Latino Entrepreneurship Initiative*. Stanford Graduate School of Business.

[4] **Alcocer, Jose J.** 2025. "[The Methodological Landscape With Respect to Identifying Gerrymandering](#)." *Amicus Libris*. Briefs from the Harvard Law School Library.

[3] **Alcocer, Jose J.** 2025. "[Facing Institutional Barriers to Sponsoring Bills in Congress, Newly Elected Minority Representatives Cosponsor Far More Than Their Non-Minority Counterparts](#)." *United States Politics and Policy (USAPP)*. London School of Economics Phelan United States Centre.

[2] Hua, Whitney, and **Jose J. Alcocer**. 2024. "[Transforming the Vote: How Voting Reforms Can Improve Equity for Underrepresented Minorities](#)." The Center for Election Science. Last Updated January 2025.

[1] Hua, Whitney, **Jose J. Alcocer**, and Mike Piel. 2024. "[America \[Mis\]Represented: 2022 Vote-Split Elections Report](#)." *The Center for Election Science*.

ONGOING RESEARCH

A.T. Graham Benjamin, **Jose J. Alcocer**, Lauren Brown, Yiorgos Chochlakis, Morteza Dehghani, Raquel Delerme, Brittany Friedman, Ellie Graeden, Preni Golazizian, Rajat Hebbar, Parsa Hejabi, Aditya Kommineni, Harry G. Muttram, Shrikanth Narayanan, Mayagüez Salinas, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, Jackson Trager, and Nicholas Weller. "[Community-Informed AI Models for Police Accountability](#)."

Muttram, Harry G., **Jose J. Alcocer**, Lauren Brown, Benjamin A.T. Graham, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, and Nicholas Weller. "[Political Control and Policing: When Do Police Comply with Police Reform?](#)"

Alcocer, Jose J., Ellie Graeden, Benjamin A.T. Graham, Harry G. Muttram, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, and Nicholas Weller. "[LLM-Driven Ontology Development for Cross-Domain Data Integration within Interdisciplinary Research](#)."

Alcocer, Jose J., Benjamin A.T. Graham, Harry G. Muttram, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, and Nicholas Weller. "[Contact-to-Consequences: Police Encounter Intensity and the Distribution of Everyday Policing](#)."

Alcocer, Jose J., Blanca E. Alonso, José E. Múzquiz, and Iskar J. Waluyo. "[Heritage Without History: Indigenous Identity and Colonial Silence in Mexican Municipal Discourse](#)."

Alcocer, Jose J., Christian R. Grose, and Seth C. McKee. "[Redistricting Redux and the Battle to Win the U.S. House in 2026](#)."

Alcocer, Jose J., and Christian R. Grose. "[Top-Two Open Primary Systems Increase Ideological Diversity in State Legislative Parties](#)."

Alcocer, Jose J. and José Múzquiz. "[Mexican Home Style: Symbolic Versus Substantive Legislative Responsiveness to Racialized Constituencies](#)."

Alcocer, Jose J. "Institutional Constraints Shape Minority Agenda-Setting: Evidence From the U.S. House (1981 – 2022)."

**PREVIOUS
PROFESSIONAL
APPOINTMENTS**

Research Analyst, 2025 – 2026
Stanford Graduate School of Business
Stanford Latino Entrepreneurship Initiative

Computational Social Scientist, 2024 – 2025
Center for Election Science, Applied Data and Research Team

Survey Statistician, 2022 – 2025
U.S. Census Bureau, Federal Statistical Research Data Center (FSRDC)

**RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE**

Research Associate, 2023 – 2025
University of Southern California, [The Security and Political Economy \(SPEC\) Lab](#)
Supervising Faculty: Benjamin A.T. Graham
Apply advanced statistical, computational, and analytical techniques to assist with ongoing projects. Assist faculty, graduate, and undergraduate students with questions on research design and statistical inference along with troubleshoot code inquiries related to R, Python, and Stata. Key contributor to [Everyday Respect](#) Project.

Research Assistant, 2021 — 2022
University of Southern California, Sol Price School of Public Policy and Gould School of Law
Primary Investigators: Abby Wood; Pamela McCann
Analyzed several U.S. federal and state executive orders for the purpose of qualitatively coding and defining different definitions of essential workers and essential business industries throughout the COVID-19 pandemic. Collected, cleaned, organized, and interpreted state-level data regarding essential worker definitions for the purpose of creating a dataset reflecting these several definitions across states. Created Python and R scripts that allowed the ability to web scrape tables from government websites and PDFs, such as the Book of the States reports. Researched and reported U.S. state differences in COVID-19 pandemic response, from their moment of closure to how they continued to evolve throughout the pandemic.

Research Associate, 2021 — 2025
University of Southern California, Democracy Lab
Supervising Faculty: Christian R. Grose
Collected, cleaned, and organized data on U.S. state legislatures and their respective representatives' policy positions on several issues. Wrote several literature reviews on the topic of legislative term limits within the context of the U.S. Collected and analyzed several quantitative regression analyses related to citizen voting behavior within the U.S. Ran several racial polarized voting analyses and ability-to-elect analyses across several U.S. states using created Python scripts streamlining the output processes.

Researcher Associate, 2019 — 2020
University of Southern California, Schaeffer Center for Health Policy and Economics

Supervising Faculty: Sarah Axeen

Collected, cleaned, and organized data from various resources to conduct several statistical analyses. Quantitatively analyzed the collected data to construct several synthetic control models of Colorado to assess the causal impact of recreational marijuana legislation at the state level. Drafted and successfully published a manuscript that investigated the effects of recreational marijuana legislation on opioid overdose rates in the state of Colorado.

Policy Analyst, 2018 – 2019

The City Project

Specialized in conducting comprehensive literature reviews on the health impacts of public parks, particularly for underprivileged urban areas, collaborating on policy research through stakeholder interviews, and contributed to agency papers and a best practices white paper on California's Proposition 68 grant process.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant

University of Southern California

Ideology and Conflict (Spring 2023)

Environmental Challenges (Fall 2022)

Instructor

University of Southern California

Python for Social Science Workshop (Spring 2023)

University of California, Los Angeles

Introduction to Programming in R (Summer 2022)

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOP PARTICIPATION

Conference Presentations

Pathways to Primary Election Reform (PPER): 2026

American Political Science Association (APSA): 2024, 2025

Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth): 2023, 2024

Election Science, Reform, and Administration (ESRA): 2024, 2026

European Political Science Association (EPSA): 2025

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2023, 2024

SoCal Political Institutions and Political Economy Conference (SoCal PIPE): 2023, 2024, 2026

Southern Political Science Association (SPSA): 2023

Western Political Science Association (WPSA): 2023, 2024

Workshops

University of Oxford, Department of Politics & International Relations: Spring School in Advanced Research Methods, 2023

Syracuse University, Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs: Institute for Qualitative and Mixed Method Research (IQMR), 2022

**GRANTS,
AWARDS, AND
FELLOWSHIPS**

University of Southern California

2024. Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award. \$3,500.00

2024. Graduate Student Government Professional Development Fund Award. \$500.00

2024. Graduate School Travel/Research Award. \$1,500.00

2023. Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award. \$4,500.00

2023. Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant. \$2,000.00

2022. Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award. \$2,500.00

2022. Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant. \$2,500.00

2021. Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award. \$2,500.00

2020. Graduate Diversity Scholarship and Tuition Fellowship Award. \$40,000.00/yr.

**PROFESSIONAL
SKILLS**

Programming and Scripting Languages: C++, JavaScript, Mata (Stata), Python, R, Rust, SQL

Markup and Styling: CSS, HTML, LaTeX

Web Applications: Google Suite, Infogram, Microsoft 365, Overleaf, Qualtrics

Updated 07/11/2026